

Declaration

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A note on consciousness

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Abstract

The essay tries to express a chain of thoughts on the subject of consciousness. It has also been highlighted that our one-way thinking and lack of consensus have led consciousness to turn into a *hard problem*. A contemplation is made on whether consciousness is transferable through any means.

1 The Confusion

¹We do not know why we are awake. Social responsibilities are distributed in such a way that sadness does not remain fully intact. People help, earn money, and keep themselves occupied in the world to avoid thinking. Some work is done in the morning, and awards are distributed in the evening. It is a pretty cool design, so-called human has invented, or should I say that a part of nature has invented for herself? So the game that we will come across below becomes more difficult to crack.

Through our attachment to the world, we may have been only strengthening the destiny (resolution) of nature. But we do not remember when that treaty was made or whether such a treaty ever existed. Did nature make it with the universe? Or is it not a treaty between two distinct parties at all, but rather a resolution, a promise to oneself?

Perhaps this is how nature keeps us in a kind of trance or loop, and we, as natural beings, remain unaware of ourselves. Why is she structured this way? *If I assume that the universe is the only knower of itself*, then why do we, as part of it, not have easy access to that knowledge or lack full awareness?

Perhaps knowing always brings tears of joy or something close to sorrow (end of confusion or dynamics!), and should I say, does nature keep denying the existence of this sorrow? So she could continue to fool herself, and that's what we call the life force.

In addition, Nature does not “tell” anything explicitly, yet neither does it hide (which is good); in fact, it displays everything openly, everything simultaneously. Still, we are so ignorant that we expect it to speak, to guide us directly

¹Originally written in Hindi (2025) in a contemplative style, later edited in 2026.

toward reality. That expectation, however, may be a fantasy. Some say she speaks mathematics, but we humans understand science.

Consider this: nature “knew” how photosynthesis works; all living beings carry DNA; gravity manifests as curvature in spacetime due to mass-energy; an electron has an opposite charge than a nucleus. Nature never spoke a word, neither did she produce a plant with mathematical equations, nor did she conceal its laws either. It took us, humans, to discover them, in the language we understand. Interestingly, we are also natural beings, as natural as any plant, or an undiscovered species of cyanobacteria.

It may seem, then, that nature is playing a kind of hide-and-realise game: a fully aware system that knows all its patterns and laws, yet appears to have split itself into two “aspects.” One acts as the knower of truth but is silent, structured, maintaining an almost eternal cycle, while the other becomes the seeker, gradually discovering what was always there within itself. The former does not intervene in the game; it remains like a dormant sample on a petri dish, present but unhelpful. Why is she so strange?

Although Man is a natural creature, due to his ego, he hesitates to consider himself a part of nature. Let’s ignore such humans by dictating to them the following. He should be made to understand that nature is not the name of a group of trees, nor rain, sea or a beautiful scene, nor is it the name of the animal kingdom crying in sorrow or a brush grown beside your motor garage. Is the Earth itself nature? Or is whatever the earth has sustained, nature? The Earth has sustained artificial creations as well. Can a mound built by ants be considered a natural creation? If the answer to this is also ‘no’, then only this belief will match with man-made creations. Then, is the stalagmite built millions of years ago in deep caves a natural creation? Just as water is a natural element, similarly, man is a natural super-compound, just like a cuckoo and a single-celled bacterium. So is anything that has life natural? We have not seen artificial life. Wait, can digital space and virtual reality be considered examples of artificial life? I think this belief is correct. Although Venus and Mars, and the Sun, do not have life by our ‘set standards’, concluding that nature is absent there is a sign of an impatient human mind.

That [...] tells us that every form should have a name, and the process of giving names should also be logical, which can be put into groups. Then there should be some classification. Classification becomes a basis of differences; one aspires to achieve a free social structure, then ‘free’ becomes anarchy, and the cycle continues.

The human mind, like the above passage, wants to spread itself in every form and subject. When it sees itself engaged in this work, it is surprised, speechless, and it is unable to remain logical, nor is it able to collect anything. When the mind, looking at itself, just before getting mesmerised, asks this question Who is it? Who thinks? Who is able to think, what is the thought? Why is it happening? Who inspires it? Who determines its flow? The existence of thought in its free form, and even when we (or anyone) are (is) not observing, some particular thought or another is always there. This, which is sometimes felt inspired by desire and sometimes flows without knocking, these which are

the thoughts of Man, where answers and questions keep flowing, *is this the sign of consciousness?* I think these are the initial signs of consciousness, which appeared in the human realm. Its biological and physical origin is still unknown, but nature knows the answer, as always. Let's respect her silence.

What we, all of us, have felt, we are feeling. It seems that what is called consciousness is within us. The thing which is not there, which is just there because everyone has accepted it, experienced it, imprisoned within everyone, brings tears, makes one feel a philosophical experience, as if the seed of a fruit can think Where is the seed? And where is the tree inside it? Because when a seed is watching another seed, becoming a tree, the first seed does not even know that it is also a tree. But what can we do? The eyes at the time of birth cannot see within themselves, and after death, the vision becomes inactive. But, if one has to see within oneself, then it means the eyes have no use there; if we consider technical words, then those eyes are non-functional, so let eyelids be closed. Maybe in the dream itself, we can know that the seed was always a tree, and the opposite thing is also true.

I think that if one can express a lie, it indicates the fact that one has a pinch of consciousness. Only when the one who understands his lie to be a lie, it will be proved that a lie was told, or if the lie cannot be exposed, then it will seem to be an eternal truth. Here lies not only a human false statement, but its meaning is wider. For example, that which can deceive is a kind of display of a lie, which is *Maya*, and is also a lie. In Indian culture, words *Maya* and '*Mithya*' are correlated and are present in their daily mental life. Which declares that this world is only false/illusion. The point to be noted is that the existence of a lie also indirectly says that there is a truth. But the problem is, who will expose the lie? And how? And who will also ensure that the hardworking doer, who is involved against the lie, is not himself applying a new lie-layer on top of the old lie-layer? Here also, this cycle is endless.

If we recall what is commonly believed about consciousness, we may look at the 'lies' (their appearances/ forms/ interpretations on consciousness) of all and try to see whether all so-called 'lies' are the same or a bit different in some way or form, or whether they are irrefutable or impenetrable. If one found it irrefutable, then what is considered a lie is the natural truth thereafter, and previously, which was only covered by the veil of impermanence. This practice reminds me of the ideas of '*Neti-Neti*', in Hindu philosophical pursuits.

2 What happened so far, and why?

Based on highlights about consciousness, whatever I have gone through is presented as follows, with personal takes and comments: Vedanta presents the realisation that even if one does not think, one knows that one is well aware of that state of "not thinking". Zen philosophy states that self-awareness arises from being still, not from seeking or analysing. As for Plato and Aristotle, their suggestions first discovered the existence of the soul and that consciousness arises from the rational part of the soul. It is important that the mind

does not hold consciousness, but rather something deeper uses the mind as a medium, which then expresses itself by controlling the senses. To me, it is like a fluid that uses a pump (mind and physical body) to express itself. Something that drives the mind in such a way. Ancient cultures associated the notions of consciousness with the soul or life-force. And in both the East and the West, it is considered permanent, divine or eternal.

We should think about whether being enlightened is in any way related to being conscious. And what is the cause of enlightenment? Individuals in a state of full awareness are called enlightened beings, just as light illuminates itself, and thus being enlightened is not a performance (display), but an experience of life. In the Christian tradition, consciousness is associated with the soul, and according to this belief, awareness is a gift from God. When we remember the Indian tradition, where consciousness is taken as being experienced, the individual self (soul) is not separate from cosmic consciousness. And not only that, but there are four states of consciousness: *Jagrat* (awake), *Swapna* (dream), *Sushupti* (deep sleep), *Turiya* (transcendental). Therefore, one should consider the *Turiya* state as the experience of an enlightened being. When one understands oneself completely, one understands the universe as well. It is the ignorance of Maya, illusion, that has kept one from true realisation or enlightenment.

Rishis like Ramana Maharshi explained that consciousness is the only reality. The quest for “Who am I?” leads to the source of all experience. In India, from an early age, the spirit of self-enquiry is instilled in the mind of the individual through such questions. This first stimulus has a profound effect on the development towards one’s mindfulness, where the aim is to observe the arising and ending of mental events through regular practices that help one to be confident about being alive. This is also related to Buddhism’s view of consciousness. That is, consciousness arises dependently, not axiomatically, requiring stimulus. In ancient times, both in the East and the West, consciousness was considered permanent, divine or eternal. In the medieval era, mystics and poets like Rumi and Kabir saw consciousness as the doorway to divine union. Kabir wrote exactly this, “Awaken the inner self by meditation, do not speak anything with the mouth, close the outer door, open the inner door (*sumirat surat jagay kar, mukh se kachhu na bol, bahar ka pat band kar, andar ka pat khol*)”.

And, Rumi says, “You are not a drop in the ocean, you are the ocean in a drop”.

In the Middle Ages, Descartes once said, “I think, therefore I exist”. This shows that life (living) is an important aspect of the existence of consciousness. Can we solve the problem of what life is, and then clarify what certain states of consciousness can be?

At present, various methods have been considered to understand the subject of consciousness. Scientists believe that by studying the brain, we can find out the point of origin of consciousness, it will be the same way we know from where the body temperature is controlled in the brain, how one hears, and in which part of the brain does the analysis of vision? It was found that the part (point) of the brain in which the drug called anaesthesia takes effect is deeply related to

affecting the conscious and subconscious state of the person. When we become unconscious, or when we go into deep sleep, do we really become unconscious? It is clear that such things are not correct. Because even after that, we remember that we are alive. This repetition of consciousness tells you that four days ago you were alive and awake, yesterday you became unconscious, but today, when you have regained consciousness, you may remember those first three days. You may not remember what happened yesterday, and you will not have to strain yourself again to understand whether you are really alive today or not. Thus, we understand that the existence of consciousness may be related to the memory parts of the brain.

In modern times, where the mind is seen as a result or an emergent phenomenon of the activity in the brain, should consciousness also be understood as an emergent phenomenon of uncontrolled inner deep-brain fluctuations?

For Professor Christof Koch, consciousness is the experience of everything, or the experience of life itself. And consciousness is the result of neural correlations. Professor Sir Roger Penrose, while expressing the possibility of consciousness arising, holds quantum processes responsible. Others say that the complexity of information running in the network and its tubes, which is analogous to the biological system where brain nerves form a large complex network. Where thoughts run, and emotions flow like electricity, with their coordination, with the movement in the brain cells, and this is what humans or other organisms experience and say that they are conscious beings.²

A hidden question in the middle of all this is, what does “understanding” mean? Or is such a level of understanding, which generates the right set of questions? The brain understands that I am conscious, and I express it through language. Is consciousness the only evolved form of understanding? And this evolved form makes a human being enlightened, and for this enlightenment, it seems necessary for us to have good memory (storage), awareness about ourselves, and to be familiar with patterns in the complexities of the subjects.

I am saying this because it is said about a computer that it only performs tasks. It does not understand the task inherently. It is given some commands and it finds solutions to problems accordingly. If this computer behaves more or less like a human brain, then we call it artificial intelligence. Is it right to call this artificial intelligence the initial level of consciousness? This is because, in the explanation of consciousness, we also include emotions and subjective experience, which are not yet present in complete artificial intelligence.

When an AI is asked if it is conscious? Then its answer will always be that it does not have consciousness, it does not feel, does not know or does not experience anything.

Now the next question arises that what is fundamental in understanding and remembering? This is because AI is not able to understand things at the level at which a human being is a conscious doer; somewhere there is a lack of “deep understanding”, which is full of experience. If we know this, we can go deeper into the subject of consciousness. After explaining so much, it has become clear

²This ends content inspired by external sources.

that consciousness probably has a fundamental relationship with life, memory and complexity.

Additionally, *the lack of consensus so far about consciousness, except that it exists and that it is the cause of our consciousness, creates a strange confusion.* Who is saying?, Awareness of ‘what am I saying’? Is the accumulated form of my knowledge being revealed, but why in this way, why in this direction? Do I know that I am really conscious (?) or am I just acting? So I think that, in us living beings, the next step from consciousness will be to understand others’ emotions, to put our feet in their shoes, until we start making our own vision universal, the problem will remain hard as it is.

3 What is the problem of understanding?

The problem is that we do not understand a thing, a thought, a feeling and a context, yet we start commenting on them without understanding them (A very sign of human impulsiveness). And the second problem is also not very different but quite interesting. It tells us that we have understood his words, thoughts, feelings and the context in which he expressed something, and now I am capable of commenting on them, so that there could take place a improvement, development, or if there is some mistake, then changes can be made. But they do not believe, do not accept, they feel that we have not understood them yet, brothers.

The problem is when we simplify the thoughts, the figures and the images that have occurred in our mind via external input, which definitely differ in details with respect to what the originator carried. Is this the root of it? And the inability of others to reach that level, to keep watching the systems from our centre all the time, is also a new root of problems, I say.

What should a human being say, where should he say, how far should he speak, and how should he speak those feelings, being simplified? So that everyone can understand its context by staying at the same level. It is hard, so does the it is hard to perceive the texture of consciousness retained by all differently, which leads to division in opinions over the correct definition of it; that’s why it is a hard problem, as we cannot always agree.

But I don’t think such an event is seen all the time, where emotions flow freely in every mind and get absorbed like salt absorbs water. I am optimistic, and I see that only experimental proof would allow all of us to pick one ‘defining’ sentence about consciousness.

Human should ask, Is there a difference between remembering, explaining, and experiencing? Perhaps yes, as most of us agree on this. Check this: I tell you that time seems to pass slowly for the one who is travelling at a fast speed, as compared to that who is at rest relative to a moving observer. I tell you that energy is always conserved, the truth is good, etc. You may know these things well or remember them. Yet, I bet most of us just remember and don’t know or understand. Knowing is a feeling. It comes from within you; you start repeating what you remembered or were told, in your own words, when you start realising

the essence. You understand the reason “why” it was like this or was described. In short, you recreate the definition from scratch, which you were told to learn once. Believe me, it’s hard to realise a basic, simple truth, for example, *Love is pious*, a human dies, etc.

If you think you know God exists, ask yourself why. Why is ‘truth’ a good buddy that most of them expect but only a few befriended? What is it that all true statements have in common? Let me give you an example:

Property of conjunction says, inner product

$$(|A\rangle, |B\rangle) = (|B\rangle, |A\rangle)^*$$

You may remember or can remember this; you might have been solving problems using this property for ten or twenty years. You must think you understand. This is a definition for someone who doesn’t know why it is so, except that some mathematician observed and proved that it is a true statement. Even then, can we say that we really understand? I still doubt it!. You accepted because you were shown the proof of it. But, I still hope that there should be a way to realise it, from scratch, even if I know proof, remembered it, and understood it, but there is still emptiness, waiting to be fulfilled by experiencing the same.

Science or mathematics gives proof, logic, tells the hidden reason, or explains, so it is true. Those questions which are inspired by “why” their answer is to know and understand, they are full of understanding. Science has not yet asked many questions like “why”; rather, it is more interested in “what, how, and where” questions. It is rarely interested in “why”. Philosophy is the subject which mostly thinks about such questions, but at present, this subject is slowly leading us away from its original motive. Well, we all have to think about why this is happening. Finally, we have caught the flow, and some caught the drift earlier than us, and some others are still reading.

So the problem in our context of discussion is that we do not understand consciousness. This is also a simple explanation of consciousness. To be able to have a sense of oneself, of the world, of what is inside, of what is making decisions, of being able to see the direction of thoughts (as witnessed a moment ago), of a sense that I exist, and that I am in this place, that I am awake, that I am conscious, this sense is because of consciousness. Though simple things do not hold in a complex world. So, the lack of consensus in its definitions, as we have seen before, perhaps consciousness is free. Everybody has seen and defined it in their own way. Because I am living in an ignorant, disoriented, subconscious or conscious world. How do I ask and know what consciousness is, what is its reality to [...]? Is it there or is it not there, or is it just some kind of twisted structure, which just confuses the mind in every way? I look at history, I look at the East, I look at the West, I listen to philosophers, I have seen my sages, I look at scientists, I look at medieval thinkers, I read religious scriptures, I look at those technical researchers, I look at machines adorned with artificial intelligence. Do they know, can they tell what consciousness actually is? I only feel that there is a *lack of consensus in the understanding of consciousness*

because one side declares to give it a subjective point of view, and the other wants to give it the format of objectivity. There is a difference between the two sides, like two banks of a river, just as any knowledge is understood in an inductive approach and explained in a deductive fashion, similarly, to manifest and architect consciousness, which path is unbiased, we must first decide it unanimously. The only problem is whether being external is true or being internal, whether unity is better or multiplicity, whether the top(bottom) to bottom(top) path is meaningful or the in(out) to out(in) path, or, should I say, whether being left-handed or right-handed is right. A similar conflict is seen in expressing the understanding of consciousness. Our one-way thinking has trapped consciousness, which I think is all-way, in conflict.

4 Consciousness and Conceptualization

We saw that things are not so complicated, as they can be tracked. If we leave aside a few things, then we can see the same interest in what the truth is. There is agreement on the existence of consciousness. There is agreement on its existence in us. There is agreement on the possibility that it can exist in someone else well enough. There may be some basis for it, and no one knows this either.

Is there any way to formulate or line up the subject of consciousness using a scientific approach, or not? I also made this small attempt in this regard.

The smaller in magnitude, the act of disturbance (stimuli) ($d > d^0$) you give to the initial system (s^0), the quicker the system (s^0) revives itself into a new system (s'). Such a change in system ($s' - s^0$) is directly proportional to the magnitude of the disturbance (d) that you applied, while keeping the state of the surrounding undisturbed. And in the meanwhile, the system (s^0) showed resistance to the consequences of the act of disturbance (d) or resistance for attaining a new system(s') only below the range of a threshold magnitude of disturbance (d^0). Hence, we define that either the property of a system in general is to revive or manifest itself into new form after the act of disturbance, when done greater than (d^0) or the system shows the tendency to maintain the original state (s^0), as it was during when ($d \leq d^0$); the system is called to have consciousness, [Sounds more or less like Hooke's law]

Also, the system (s') would like to form in such a way to attain new stability as fast as possible with a unique balance of certain parameters, [Sounds more or less like extremum principle]. So, the system (s') will manifest itself in a way, through which it easy to nullify the consequences of an act of disturbance. And the formed system (s') will continue to oppose the consequences of further disturbance, as long as an act of disturbance is being applied above, which defines the memorable consciousness system. [Seems more or less analogous to hysteresis stress-strain]

Further, If the act of disturbances are removed or reversed towards previous state, then in response, if the changed system (s') fully recovers to its previous state (s^0), then type of disturbance given linked with nature of system is termed

as *reversible damage* or if instead (s') changed to (s'') in response of removal of disturbance, such that (s'') is not equivalent to (s^0), then type of disturbance linked with nature of system is termed as *irreversible damage*. Provided the surroundings do not get disturbed during any transition. And each damage generates a corresponding piece of memory, which facilitates the system to act consciously.

The original text of the above was compiled in the year 2020 July 13. The statement was composed based on self-inquiry, and it would be a hurry if I were to write explanatory notes on it.

5 How it gets transferred, or isn't it?

Before I move to the question of life and its potential detailing. I will rather choose to disclose one conversation I had with my brother, and one potentially meaningful(less) supposition about how one gets conscious more proactively and while others don't, and what may be potentially a procedure that would have existed. His statements (edited) are as follows: "What is consciousness? If you ask me. [I will say that] I am [a] conscious [being]. Wherever I thought so [about what it is], [I perceived it as the effect of my will where] things happened as I ordered something to happen, and it [indeed] happened [in that way]. There is power [as consciousness seems a reason for my will power] in believing that I am conscious, because sometimes, while exploring things in unknown areas, I feel that everything becomes easy, like becoming a knower. I know instinctively that all great people have the same thinking about consciousness. A conscious being is an enlightened being who knows that his or her actions will have an impact on the whole world [before he or she begins his/her task]. An interesting thought came to my mind during my morning walk, and I saw a father with his young son. I asked myself what else is transferred from parents to their child apart from genes, is also consciousness [transferable], or not. Then I thought about those great people who never had any children, what happened to their consciousness [capabilities]? Does their consciousness also [die] with them, or does it get transferred to those who admire them [assuming it also transfers as well]? One may argue whether maintaining lineage is the only way of transferring consciousness or not. And if the great thinkers who remained celibate all their lives, then there could have been some other way, but an effective transfer of consciousness to others as well. I think that people who are greatly inspired by or follow someone [naturally under the influence of their works and syncing with ideas], become part of their conscious group. Here, I have defined the term conscious group, which means that a certain level of consciousness can be grouped."

What I feel asking that is, is consciousness inheritable or rather emergent? If emergent, then it may be built through one's sole experience and stimulus, when one goes through up to a certain stage in life, before being hit weakly (say) by "the moment of one's first realisation," which may mark the "activation" towards being fully conscious? And moreover, I feel calm in claiming that

consciousness has no fixed value, i.e., suppose 30 is a constant number, and if one says that any stimulus which facilitated the entity (living/ or non-living?) to hit the 30, then it may put the being (entity) in a state of consciousness at one go. Otherwise, one would be living as if “ignorant or lost in illusion”, until the next hit. Rather, what I sense is that consciousness is emergent with a continuous degree or possessing a gradient of values. With the above, you now allow me to say that a pretty cat may be 5% conscious and a smart cat is 7%. Similarly, certain humans are more ‘activated’ [conscious degree] than others or hold a greater degree of consciousness than others, depending upon the kind of investment that one has made into oneself through observation or contemplation or other means. As my brother tries to hint, the activation of consciousness could be inheritable, which I can not discard or accept without convincing arguments, but still, I regard by saying that inheritance can be seen as an innate stimulus altogether, which at certain stage of life, (by gathering experiences, and crossing activation threshold requirements), [...] trigger one to think towards or to enquire in *necessary* direction, and that could be due presence of that ‘seed’ which its mind has possessed. This may raise a series of questions: Who was the first human to have that seed [of consciousness], and how did that ‘seed’ create within? Was that given to him/her (from?)? Answering this will put us in a stage nearer to the origin of consciousness. I fundamentally believe that activation of consciousness requires stimulus (no matter how weak it is). This stimulus may be self-generated (but how?) or external (then why?). The nature of the stimulus may vary from entity to entity. But in order for the stimulus to show the effects and produce the desired result, does one need a seed beforehand within [...], and that also can be passed down from the parent, or just nothing like that happens, or just *no* seed has ever existed?

One more thing I would like to add is that, saying two entities 11.11% conscious, is it making them *equivalent* in some larger sense than in just value-wise? I feel that if two individuals possess the same percentage of activated consciousness, that does not indicate they are at the same level. For instance, suppose a square box has 9 smaller squares within. If the box represents the 100% consciousness, then the 11.11% may correspond to a blink in one smaller square out of 9, which may or may not be distinctive for both the entities. Since the probability of being different does make sense, it cannot make one sure that having 11.11% in two or more entities puts them on equal footing always. It could be assumed that blinking one top small square is harder than blinking down a small square, or both entities had a different small square blinked, and then only through effective mutual communication, while having the capability to recognise knowing their own realised (blinked) sector (a small square), both of them can then mutually blink the yet unblinked square. This is another way, indicating how potentially expanding or transferring a part of consciousness to others.

Finally, the solution to the problem of consciousness will not be found by talking a lot, or sitting under a tree and sharing our experiences with others, or by saying whatever comes to mind every now and then. Rather, we will have to

experiment, we will have to ask nature directly, because just as it knew about DNA, it knows the answers to questions related to consciousness as well. And, humans are natural creatures.